

nects smaller networks in the Internet. The ISP who provides you with the internet connection is the last link in a long chain of local, regional, national, pan-national, and international networks that connect to each other through a global Internet backbone. In one sense this is the main information highway along which zips large volumes of data going to and fro across the globe.

7.2.10 Bandwidth

This refers to the amount of data you can send through a modem connection or through the network and is measured in bits per second or bps. When you can send data in multiples of thousands, it is referred to as Kbps (Kilo bits per second) and in Mbps (Mega bits per second). Most modern LANs operate at 100 Mbps. Those with the latest technology operate at 1 Gbps (Gigabits per second) or 1024 Mbps. In comparison, bandwidth through a dial up modem is a measly 56 Kbps and through broadband DSL 256 Kbps and upwards. We are just starting to see the spread of 1 Mbps and above broadband connections.

7.2.11 Banner Ad

Nearly 90 per cent of the Internet is run on advertising, and one of the most ubiquitous tools used to deliver ads is the banner ad. This is the rectangular block of advertisement that you use at the top of most Web pages. They are usually 468 x 60 pixels. Ads used to be plain HTML with graphics and images, but these days as the internet user gets more and more sophisticated banner ads have also morphed. Nowadays banner ads use multiple gimmicks to attract the user including Flash movies, animations and more.

7.2.12 BCC

Blind Carbon Copy. For anyone who has ever sent e-mail, the BCC field is the one you use when you don't want the main e-mail recipient to know that the same message is being delivered to one or more people other than the main recipient himself (or herself!). It is also a good practice, or netiquette as its known, to use BCC when you are sending a message to multiple people. By using BCC you will be prevent one recipient from knowing the e-mail id of